Stellar Cyber 6.6.0s is now live! Discover all the updates in the release notes!

Installing a Windows Server Sensor

Learn more at Stellar Cyber Academy.

The following links take you to courses on the Stellar Cyber Academy technical training portal where you can learn more about a topic by watching the suggested lessons.

M05 Open XDR Windows Server Sensor Installation and Configuration (02h:45m)

Introduction (07m:00s)

Start with an overview of installing and configuring the Stellar Cyber Windows Server Sensor. Explore how this sensor integrates with the Stellar Cyber Platform, covering data collection, configuration, and advanced monitoring options like Sysmon and file integrity.

Overview (15m:00s)

Learn about the role of the Windows Server sensor within the Stellar Cyber Platform, including compatibility requirements and network configurations. Understand the process for sending server event data—like security events and system logs—through the data processor for analysis.

Software Installation (18m:00s)

Follow a step-by-step walkthrough of installing the Windows Server sensor software, from downloading the package through the knowledge base to completing essential configurations. Learn how to assign tenant IDs, bind the sensor to the Stellar Cyber Platform, and verify connectivity to network and data processor endpoints.

Authorization (15m:00s)

Learn how to authorize the Windows Server sensor within the data processor, then watch a live demonstration of the complete process in the data processor UI. Follow the steps to set up a custom sensor profile, link and bind the sensor, and verify authorization status to confirm connectivity and ensure data transfer readiness to the Stellar Cyber Platform.

Validate Installation and Authorization (14m:00s)

Confirm the installation and authorization of the Windows sensor by checking for active connections in both the Windows Agent CLI and the Stellar Cyber Platform UI. Follow a hands-on demonstration to validate sensor functionality, verify sensor status in the data processor, and monitor incoming Windows event data flowing to the data lake.

Advanced Configuration - Audit Policy (14m:00s)

Discover how to expand the range of Windows events captured by adjusting audit policies, then follow a hands-on demonstration of configuring those policies to increase event visibility in the Stellar Cyber Platform. Learn to enable additional security event types sent to the data lake, supporting more comprehensive threat analysis and monitoring across your environment.

Advanced Configuration - Sensor Profile (18m:00s)

Customize sensor profiles using predefined templates that align with specific security requirements, enabling granular control over data collection and processing. Watch a demo on selecting and applying templates, fine-tuning event settings, and monitoring enhanced data flow to the data processor within the Stellar Cyber Platform.

Advanced Configuration - Sysmon (28m:00s)

Learn how to install and configure Sysmon on Windows Server to enhance security visibility through detailed event monitoring. Explore how Sysmon logs capture process creation, network connections, and file changes, then follow a step-by-step demonstration covering the configuration steps required to ensure Windows Server events are captured and forwarded as Interflow records to the data processor for ingestion into the data lake.

Advanced Configuration - File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) (18m:00s)

Enable File Integrity Monitoring (FIM) on the Stellar Cyber Platform to track and detect unauthorized modifications to critical files on Windows Servers. Learn to configure FIM settings for accurate file change tracking, then follow a hands-on demo to validate the setup and confirm that file change events are captured and forwarded correctly within the data lake for further analysis.

Advanced Configuration - Windows Channel Logging (28m:00s)

Configure Windows Channel Logging in the Stellar Cyber Platform to capture events from various Windows Server functions and roles. Follow a demo walkthrough to set up logging channels that target specific event types, improving data collection and enhancing event visibility across your environment.

Troubleshooting (23m:00s)

Address common issues in sensor installation and configuration by exploring troubleshooting techniques for connectivity problems, configuration errors, and other sensor-related challenges within the Stellar Cyber Platform. Follow along with a step-by-step demo that walks through diagnosing and resolving errors encountered during installation and configuration workflows.

The first time you access a link on the portal during a session, you must log in to access content.

This topic describes how to install a Windows Server Sensor in a supported target environment using the installation file downloaded from the **Download Images** tab in the **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation** page. Refer to the following sections for details:

- **About the Windows Server Sensor**
- **Supported Windows Server Versions**
- **Open Firewall Ports**
- **Obtaining the Windows Server Sensor Installer**
- **Obtaining a Token for the Installation**
- **Installing the Windows Server Sensor**
- **Configuring the Server Sensor in the CLI**
    - **Using a Proxy with the Windows Server Sensor**
- **Uninstalling the Server Sensor**

About the Windows Server Sensor

The Windows Server Sensor (agent) runs as a Windows service in a compatible Windows Server system. The Server Sensor observes events within the Windows Server system and sends Interflow data records to the data processor.

The captured events are:

- Hardware
- Security
- System
- Windows Firewall
- Windows Defender
- PowerShell

The Windows Server Sensor provides the following key capabilities:

- If the sensor has coverage over the domain controller, Stellar Cyber enriches data with the relationship between users and IP addresses.
- If the sensor has coverage over the DHCP server, Stellar Cyber sees the relationship between hostnames and IP addresses, and so can track assets when the IP address changes.
- Windows Server Sensor provides the data foundation for Stellar Cyber's machine learning alerts that use the Windows Events index.

  Although you can also provide coverage of Windows logs using other visibility tools such as the ManageEngine Log Collector or Winlogbeat, the logs provided by these tools are not normalized, enriched, and stored in the Windows Events index used for

machine learning alert generation (except for ManageEngine ADAudit Plus logs) and cannot be used for machine learning alert generation.

In addition, the Windows Server Sensor provides the following advantages over alternative solutions:

- Windows Server Sensor provides easier deployment and maintenance.
- Windows Server Sensor provides granular filtering at the edge through the Stellar Cyber user interface.
- By using the Windows Server Sensor, you do not need to deploy another modular sensor to forward logs from ManageEngine or Winlogbeat.

Windows Server Sensor Processes

The Windows Server Sensor launches the following processes:

Name in Task Manager	Name in Services App	Description
aella_conf_win_srv.exe	Windows Agent Sensor Conf	Handles Windows Server Sensor configuration
aella_ctrl_win_srv.exe	Windows Agent Sensor Ctrl	Monitors other services, and can stop or start them based on the configuration
aella_winlog.exe	Windows Agent Sensor Logbeat	Sends Windows events to DP
aella_filebeat.exe	Windows Agent Sensor Filebeat	Sends log files from Windows DHCP server (if installed and running) to DP or acts as syslog forwarder if **Filebeat** is enabled in the Sensor Profile
aella_fim.exe	Windows Agent Sensor FIM	Provides file integrity monitoring services, as configured in the Sensor Profile
aella_diagnostics_win_srv.exe	Windows Agent Sensor Phonehome	Sends Windows Server Sensor logs to DP

Windows Server Sensor Indices

Data collected by the Windows Server Sensor can feed the following Stellar Cyberindices:

- Traffic (`aella-adr-*`)
- Windows Event Log (`aella-wineventlog-*`)
- Sensor Monitoring (`aella-ade-*`)

Supported Windows Server Versions 6.3.0

The Windows Server Sensor is supported in the following environments:

- Windows Server 2008 R2, 2012, 2012 R2, 2016, 2019, 2022 21H2 (Server Desktop Experience), and 2025.

The same **.msi** installation file is used for all Windows Server Sensor installations. The Server Sensor is only available in 64-bit.

When the system sleeps, the connection drops, and no data is collected. The connection is re-established when the system wakes. To avoid this, configure Windows to **Never** sleep.

The host Windows Server into which the Windows Server Sensor is installed must meet the following minimum requirements, regardless of whether it is a physical or virtual server:

Component	Specification
Host CPU	Xeon Core 2 virtual cores (2.0 GHz or more)
Host RAM	8 GB
Available SSD Disk Space	Minimum – 5 GB Recommended – 8 GB

Update Windows Server Software Before Installing Windows Server Sensor

Stellar Cyber recommends that you use Windows Update to make sure your Windows Server software is up to date before installing the Windows Server Sensor.

Clean Up Existing 4.3.x Installations in Windows Server 2008 R2 or 2012 R2 Before Installing 6.6.0

Stellar Cyber recommends that you fully uninstall any 4.3.x Windows Server Sensors from Windows Server 2008 R2 or 2012 R2 environments before installing the 6.6.0 software. Note the following:

- Use the uninstall procedure provided in **Uninstalling the Server Sensor**.
- Make sure you check the following boxes during the uninstall:
  - **Remove Data Files**
  - **Remove Scheduler Task**
  - **Remove Stellar Syswatcher**
- When the uninstallation completes, manually delete the **C:\ProgramData\StellarCyber** folder.

PowerShell Not Required

PowerShell is not required for Windows Server Sensor installations.

Exclude Server Sensor from AV/EDR Scanning

Stellar Cyber recommends that you prevent potential conflicts by configuring any anti-virus or EDR software installed on the same host as the Server Sensor to exclude the Server Sensor installation directories from scanning. The directories to exclude for a Windows Server Sensor are as follows:

Server Sensor Type	Folders/Files to Exclude from AV/EDR Scanning
Windows	C:\ProgramData\Stellarcyber

Server Sensor Type	Folders/Files to Exclude from AV/EDR Scanning
	C:\Program\Aella C:\Windows\Stellar_syswatcher.exe (sensors running pre-4.2.2 versions)

Possible False Positives from FireEye PROCGUARD

During installation of the Windows Server Sensor, it is possible that FireEye PROCGUARD may report the following alert – `Attempted LSASS access by aella_conf_win_srv.exe detected`. After investigation, Stellar Cyber has determined that this is a false positive and that the `aella_conf_win_srv.exe` service does not interact with `C:\\Windows\\system32\\lsass.exe` on the host machine.

Open Firewall Ports

The sensor requires open firewall ports in order to communicate.

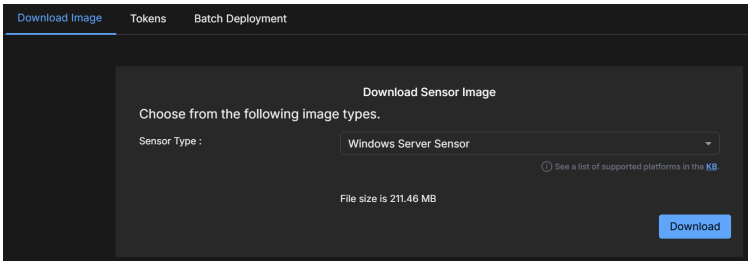
Obtaining the Windows Server Sensor Installer

You download the installation file for the Windows Server Sensor from the **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation page**. Use the following procedure:

Only users with the **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation | Sensor Image Download** privilege assigned to their profile in the System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Role-Based Access Privileges interface can download images.

1. Navigate to **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation**.
2. Set the **Sensor Type** dropdown to **Windows Server Sensor**.

   The display updates to show you the size of the files to be downloaded.



3. Click **Download**.

   The system downloads the **.msi** installation file to the system's Downloads folder.

The next step is to use the **Tokens** tab to obtain the token you will use to install the downloaded sensor, as described below.

Obtaining a Token for the Installation

Tokens are required to authorize and configure the installation of a sensor image downloaded from the DP in the **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor**

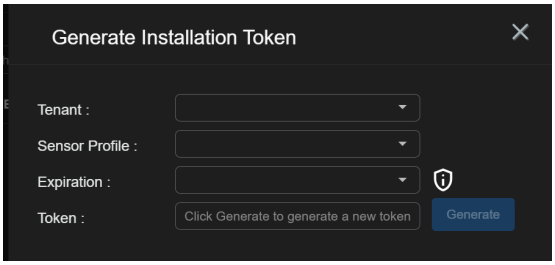
Installation page. Tokens point the installed sensor to the correct DP, assign the selected tenant and sensor profile, and authorize the sensor installation.

Use the following procedure to obtain a token in the Tokens tab:

1. Navigate to **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation** and click on the **Tokens** tab.
2. If a token already exists for the target tenant for the sensor installation, **Copy** it to the clipboard or **Download** it as a file.
    - Copy the token if you plan on pasting it into an msiexec command or the installation wizard's dialog box.
    - Download the token as a file if you plan on referring to it in the msiexec command, hosting it at a URL, or pointing to it in the installation wizard's dialog box.

    Refer to **Assigning Tokens** for a summary of the different ways in which tokens can be applied to a sensor installation.
3. If there is not already an unexpired token for the target tenant that you want to use, click the **Generate** button.

    The Generate Installation Token dialog appears:

4. Select the Sensor Profile to be assigned to all sensors authorized with this token from the **Sensor Profile** dropdown. The dropdown lists all sensor profiles available in the System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Profiles page for the selected Tenant.

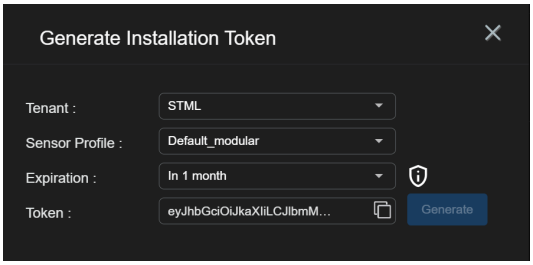
    If you do not want to assign a Sensor Profile with a token, you can set this field to **None (no sensor profile selected)**. This is also the setting for any tokens migrated from a pre-5.3.0 release as part of an upgrade.
5. Use the **Expiration** dropdown to select an expiration date for this token. You can select specified expiration dates ranging from two weeks to three months.

    You can also select **Never expires** for the expiration date. However, Stellar Cyber recommends that you specify expiration dates for your tokens in order to improve the security of your deployment.

    Remember that when a token expires, **sensors authorized with the token continue to operate as normal**. Once a sensor successfully registers with the Stellar Cyber platform, it no longer uses the token. It is only used for the initial authorization, registration, and configuration of the sensor.

6. Click the **Generate** button.

   The system generates a token and displays its contents in the **Token** field. The dialog also updates to display the expiration date for the token, as illustrated below.



7. You can use the **Copy** button to copy the token to the clipboard immediately, or simply close the dialog and retrieve the token from the **Tokens** tab later on.
8. You can use the **Copy** button to copy the token to the clipboard immediately, or simply close the dialog and retrieve the token from the **Tokens** tab later on.

Installing the Windows Server Sensor

You can install the Windows Server Sensor using any of the following techniques. Each technique requires the use of the token you obtained in the previous section to authorize and configure the installation.

Single Installation Using Wizard	This is the simplest scenario, where you are installing a single Windows Server Sensor interactively on a target machine using the GUI-based installation wizard. Refer to **Installing the Windows Server Sensor Using the Wizard**.
Single Installation from Command Line	You can also install a single Windows Server Sensor using an msiexec command and the **.msi** installer downloaded from the **Download Images** tab in the **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation page**. The proper syntax for the msiexec command, including a selected token, is provided in the **MSI File Installation** section of the **Batch Deployment** tab in the **Sensor Installation** page. Refer to **MSI File Installation**.
Bulk Installation Using a Script	You can create your own scripts for bulk installations using the msiexec command provided in the **MSI File Installation** section of the **Batch Deployment** tab in the **Sensor Installation** page. As described in **About Tokens**, the same token can be reused to authorize multiple sensor installations for the same tenant. Refer to **MSI File Installation**.
Bulk Installation Using GPO	You can also use Microsoft Group Policy Object (GPO) to deploy the Window Server Sensor to multiple systems at once. You do this by using the **GPO Bulk Installations** tool in the **Batch Deployment** tab in the **Sensor Installation** page. This tool helps you download a zip file containing a batch file preconfigured with a selected token. You can use the contents of the zip file to generate an MST file that can be used with GPO to deploy the Window Server Sensor to multiple systems at once. Refer to **GPO Bulk Installations**

Installing the Windows Server Sensor Using the Wizard

Use the following procedure to install the Windows Server Sensor interactively using the wizard:

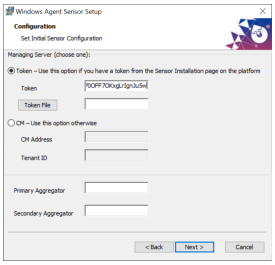
During the installation, a Windows command prompt window may appear. Do not close this window manually – the installation wizard closes it automatically when the installation is complete.

To avoid installation issues, complete any pending updates for the host Windows machine before upgrading the Server Sensor.

1. Open the folder where you downloaded the .msi installation file from the **Download Image** tab in **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation**.
2. Right-click the .msi file and select **Properties** from the context menu that appears.
3. Select **Unblock** in the **Security** section.

   Some Windows systems automatically block downloaded files.
4. Select **OK**.
5. Double-click the .msi file to open it and start the installation. Accept any system warnings presented by User Account Control
6. Click **Next** on the Welcome screen.
7. Choose the path for the installation when prompted by the wizard and click **Next**.
8. Select the **Token** option and supply the token to be used for the installation. You can use either of the following techniques:
   - Paste the token you copied from the **Token tab in the System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation page** into the **Token** field.
   - Select **Token File** and navigate to the location of the token file you downloaded from the **Token** tab in the **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensor Installation** page.

   The figure below shows a token pasted into the **Token** field:

   Do not use the **CM** options. These options are only used with Stellar Cyber platforms that do not have an "s" in their version number. If your Stellar Cyber platform includes the **Sensor Installation** page and the **Tokens** tab, use the **Token** option with the token file you already obtained.
9. **(Optional)** Configure a Primary and Secondary aggregator:

- **Primary Aggregator** – If you are configuring this Server Sensor to forward data to an aggregator before it is sent to the DP, you can enter the primary aggregator's IP address here.
- **Secondary Aggregator** – If you are configuring this Server Sensor to forward data to an aggregator, you can enter the secondary aggregator's IP address here.

> The wizard does not prevent you from specifying a Secondary Aggregator if the Primary Aggregator is left empty. However, a Secondary Aggregator specified without a Primary Aggregator is ignored and not applied to the installation.

10. Select **Install** to begin the installation.

    The installer installs the Server Sensor to `C:\Program Files\Aella\`, displaying a confirmation dialog box when complete.

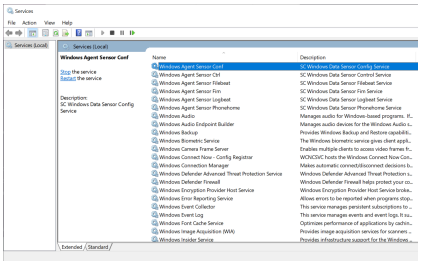
    > The Windows Server Sensor is always installed to `C:\Program Files\Aella\`. Custom paths are not supported.

11. Select **Finish**.

    The Server Sensor is installed as a service.

You can verify the installation using any of the following techniques:

- Check the **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensors** list in the user interface to see that the sensor has registered itself successfully.
- Open the **Services** app and look for the **Windows Agent Sensor Ctrl** entry.



- Access the Server Sensor's CLI and run the `show version` command. Verify that the `CM Controller` field lists the DP from which you downloaded the token for the sensor.

Windows Control Panel Shows Extra Digit in Sensor Version Number

The Windows Control Panel includes an extra leading digit in the Server Sensor version number so that, for example, a Version 6.3.0 sensor is shown with a version number of **6**.6.3.0. The extra digit is added by the sensor's installation package and can be ignored.

Assigning a Token to the Server Sensor from the CLI

As described in **Assigning Tokens**, you can apply a token to an installed sensor from the sensor CLI with the `set token` command. This can be useful if you need to change a token from the CLI after the Server Sensor has already been installed. Refer to the table below for a summary of the available techniques:

You only need to use **one** of the options in the table below. These are just different ways to do the same thing – apply t oken.

Option 1. Copy and Paste the Token String	Copy the token string from the **Tokens** tab and paste it into the CLI command. The syntax is as follows: `set token string <pasted string>`

Option 2. Upload the Token as a File to the Sensor	Download the token as a file from the **Tokens** tab, upload it to the sensor, and reference it in the `set token` command. The syntax is as follows:
	`set token file <path to local file>`
	For example, the following command points to the `token.text` file stored in the `/tmp` folder:
	`set token file /tmp/token.text`
	This technique only works for Server Sensors. There isn't a way to upload the token.text file to a newly installed modular sensor virtual machine.

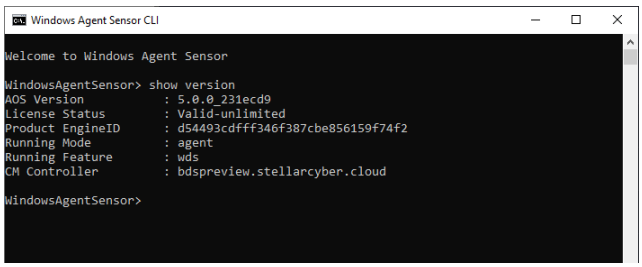
Option 3. Host the Token on an HTTP Server	Download the token as a file from the **Tokens** tab, upload it to an HTTP server, and reference it in the `set token` command. The syntax is as follows: `set token url http://<url to token>` You can also use an HTTPS server. In that case, the specified URL must also include the username and password for the server.

Configuring the Server Sensor in the CLI

Applying a token to the Server Sensor automatically configures it with the correct IP address of its managing DP and its tenant assignment. It also authorizes the Server Sensor. These are all settings that required manual configuration in previous versions and are no longer required.

However, it is still useful to access the sensor's CLI to verify its operation and change any necessary settings. To run the Server Sensor's CLI, find the **Windows Agent Sensor Command Line Interface** entry in the Windows Start Menu. If it does not appear at first, use the **Find** function.

After starting the Windows Server Sensor CLI, a terminal window appears as below. This window lets you enter CLI commands to the Server Sensor. Enter the `show version` command to verify the sensor's operations. In response, the sensor displays output similar to the following:



Using a Proxy with the Windows Server Sensor

If your Windows Server Sensor does not have direct access to the Internet, you can configure it to use an HTTP proxy for connection to the DP.

Your HTTP proxy must allow SSL on TCP ports 443 and 8889. The **set proxy <proxy> test** command described in the procedure below verifies that the necessary ports are open.

You configure the Windows Server Sensor to use an HTTP proxy in the CLI. The procedure is as follows:

The CLI prevents you from entering non-printable characters as part of the username or password for the proxy, as well as the proxy itself.

1. Access the Server Sensor's CLI.
2. First, we'll use the **set proxy <proxy> test** command to verify that our proxy is reachable and that SSL is accepted on both TCP 443 and 8889.

   Enter the **<proxy>** in the following format:

   `http://[username:password@]<proxy_ip>[:<proxy_port>]`

   Stellar Cyber recommends that you always test a proxy successfully before setting it.

   The following example shows an unsuccessful test for a proxy server on **10.1.2.3:8081**, followed by a successful test for the same IP address on port **8080**:

   ```
   WindowsAgentSensor> set proxy http://user:pass@10.1.2.3:8081 test
   Test HTTP/HTTPS proxy: http://user:pass@10.1.2.3:8081
   Failed testing dev-demo.stellarcyber.cloud:443, err: timed out

   WindowsAgentSensor> set proxy http://10.1.2.3:8080 test
   Test HTTP/HTTPS proxy: http://10.1.2.3:8080
   Passed testing dev-demo.stellarcyber.cloud:443
   Passed testing receiver-dev-demo.stellarcyber.cloud:8889
   ```

3. Once you've verified that your proxy is working correctly, you can set it with the same command but leaving out the **test** parameter. For example:

   ```
   WindowsAgentSensor> set proxy http://10.1.2.3:8080
   Succeed setting proxy
   ```

Other Proxy Commands

The following additional commands are useful when working with proxies:

- **Removing a Proxy** – `unset proxy`
- **Showing Configured Proxies** – `show proxy`
- **Review set proxy Syntax** – `set proxy ?`

Troubleshooting a Proxy

This section lists some error messages you may see when configuring a proxy along with troubleshooting tips for each.

Your first line of defense when troubleshooting a proxy is the **show proxy** command. You can use this to verify the current proxy configuration and ensure that things are set up the

way you intended them to be.

- `Failed testing xxx.stellarcyber.cloud:443, err: timed out`

  This error message can appear when the sensor can not reach the proxy server. Check your proxy configuration with **show proxy**.

- `Failed testing xxx.stellarcyber.cloud:443, err: [Errno 10061] No connection could be made because the target machine actively refused it`

  This error message indicates that the sensor could reach the proxy server but the proxy server did not accept the connection. Check whether the proxy service is up and running on the specified port and if there are any firewalls along the way that might be rejecting the connection.

- `Failed testing receiver-xxx.stellarcyber.cloud:8889, code 403`

  This error message is most likely triggered because of the proxy server's configuration. For example:

  - The proxy server may not allow port 8889 for SSL connections.
  - The proxy server may not allow clients to connect to the `receiver-xxx.stellarcyber.cloud` host.

- `Failed testing receiver-xxx.stellarcyber.cloud:8889, code 503`

  This error message usually indicates that the proxy server could not get a response from `receiver-xxx.stellarcyber.cloud:8889` (that is, the destination DP).

Sending DHCP Server Logs to a Modular Sensor

If the sensor has coverage over the DHCP server, you can send the DHCP server logs to a modular sensor with the log forwarder feature enabled so that they can be used to enrich assets with DHCP data. Configure this feature in the CLI as follows:

1. Use the following command to forward DHCP logs to a specified modular sensor:

   `set dhcp_log enable ip <sensor ip address>`

   For the `<sensor ip address>`, supply the IP address of a modular sensor with the log forwarder feature enabled in its sensor profile.

   To use this feature, you must open port 5044 for DHCP beats in any firewalls between the Server Sensor and the receiving modular sensor.

2. Verify the data entry with the `show version` command.
3. Enter the `quit` command to close the CLI.

Filebeat and dhcp_log Are Mutually Exclusive

The `dhcp_log` option is mutually exclusive with the Filebeat feature that lets Windows Server Sensors act as a forwarder for syslog records. – you can use one or the other, but not both.

If you apply a Sensor Profile with **Filebeat** enabled to a Windows Server Sensor with the `dhcp_log` feature enabled, the **Filebeat** settings do not take affect. You must disable `dhcp_log`

before you use the **Filebeat** feature.

Keep in mind that DHCP logs have been included with standard Windows Event Logs since the Windows Server 2012 release.

Uninstalling the Server Sensor

You can remove the Windows Server Sensor using the standard uninstall workflow from the Windows **Programs and Features** control panel.

During the uninstall, you can choose whether to preserve or remove the following:

- **Remove Data Files**
- **Remove Scheduler Task**
- **Remove Stellar Syswatcher**

If you are planning on reinstalling the Server Sensor, Stellar Cyber recommends that you leave these items unchecked.

To uninstall completely, check each of these options to ensure that the program and all of its data are removed completely.

During the uninstallation, a Windows command prompt window may appear. Do not close this window manually – it closes automatically when the uninstallation is complete.

About Sysmon in this Release

The Windows Server Sensor installation does not download and install the **stellar_syswatcher** (Microsoft Sysmon64) service due to potential system crashes in certain operating systems (Windows 2008R2 and 2012, although possibly others).

You can install the latest version of Sysmon (v13.31 at this writing) manually if you want the Windows Server Sensor to report Sysmon events to the DP. However, Stellar Cyber strongly recommends that you test your installation in a non-production environment to verify operations before moving to production.

Use the following procedure to download Sysmon from Microsoft, install it manually, and verify operations:

1. Install the Windows Server Sensor using the instructions earlier in this topic.
2. Download the latest version (v13.31) of Sysmon from Microsoft and extract it to the system where you want to install it.
3. Install Sysmon64 with the stellar_syswatcher.xml configuration file.
4. Restart the winlogbeat service.

   If you install sysmon *after* the Windows Server Sensor, you must restart the **winlogbeat** service so that it works with Sysmon. If you install Sysmon *before* the Windows Server Sensor, Sysmon works with **winlogbeat** without a restart.

5. Verify that Sysmon64 is installed correctly.

6. Verify that Sysmon events are received properly in the DP's **aella-adr** index.

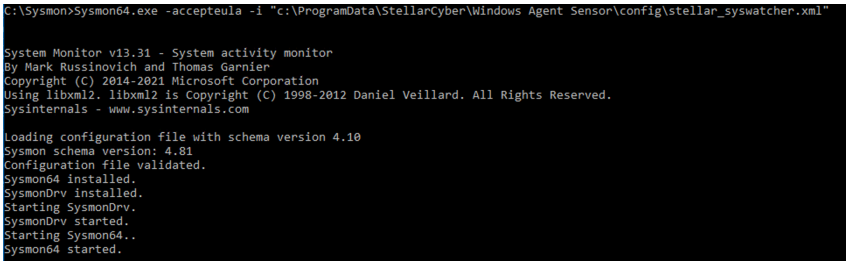
Install Sysmon64 with stellar_syswatcher

After downloading and unzipping the installer for Sysmon64 to the target system, you can install it as follows:

1. Open a command prompt as an administrator (right-click the **cmd.exe** file in Windows Explorer and choose **Run as administrator**).
2. Change directories to the directory where you unzipped the Sysmon64.exe installer.
3. Install **Sysmon64.exe** with the **stellar_syswatcher.xml** configuration file using the following command:

   ```
   Sysmon64.exe -accepteula -i "c:\ProgramData\StellarCyber\Windows Agent Sensor\config\stellar_syswatcher.xml"
   ```

   In response, the system installs and starts the Sysmon64 utility:

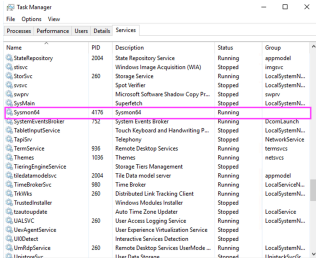
Restart the winlogbeat Service if the Windows Server Sensor is Already Installed

- If you install Sysmon *after* the Windows Server Sensor, you must restart the **winlogbeat** service so that it works with Sysmon.
- If you install Sysmon *before* the Windows Server Sensor, Sysmon works with **winlogbeat** without a restart.

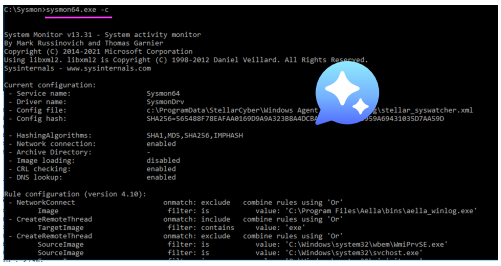
Verify Sysmon64 Installation

You can verify that Sysmon64 was installed correctly by performing the following tasks:

1. Open the Task Manager (**Ctrl-Alt-Del -> Task Manager**) and verify that the Sysmon64 service appears in the list.

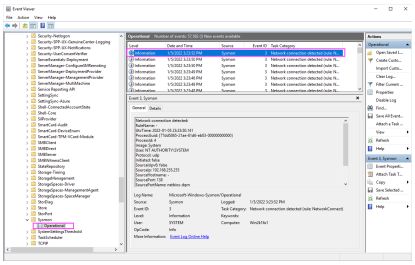
2. Return to the command prompt and run **sysmon64.exe -c** to view its current configuration. Verify that the configuration you see matches the configuration shown below:



3. Open the Windows Event Viewer and navigate to the following path in the left navigation pane:

   Applications and Services Logs | Microsoft | Windows | Sysmon | Operational

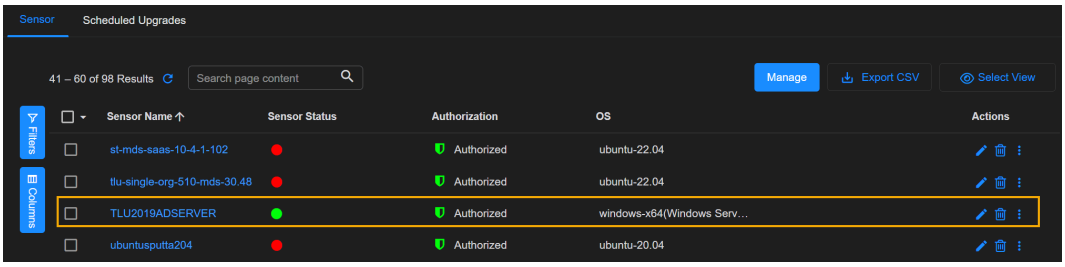
4. Verify that **Network connection detected** (Event ID 3) events appear in the list as highlighted in the figure below:



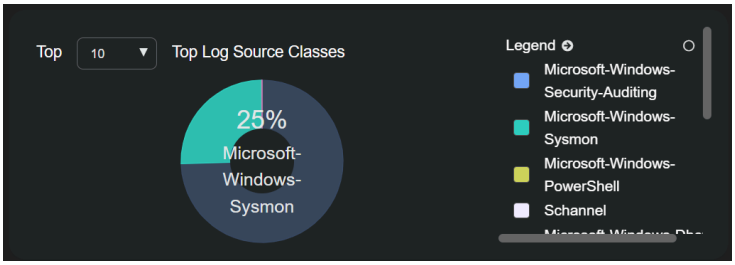
Verify Sysmon Events are Received on DP

You can verify that the manually installed Sysmon64 service is successfully sending events to the DP with the following procedure:

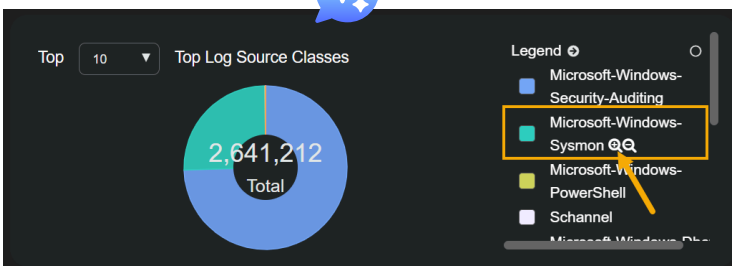
1. Connect to the DP managing the Windows Server Sensor and navigate to **System | DATA SOURCE MANAGEMENT | Sensors | Sensors**.
2. Take note of the name of the sensor where you installed the Sysmon64 service. For example:



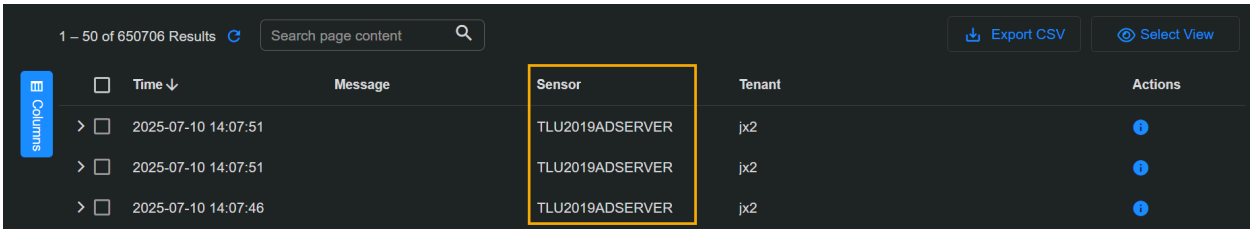
3. Navigate to the **Threat Hunting** page.
4. Set the **Indices** dropdown to **Windows Events**.
5. Locate the **Top Log Source Classes** panel and verify that it includes **Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon**, as in the figure below:



6. Click the button next to the entry for **Microsoft-Windows-Sysmon** in the **Legend** to use it as a filter. For example:



7. Scroll down to the **Documents** table.
8. Use the **Change Columns** button to add the **Sensor** column to the display if it is not already there.
9. Sort by the **Sensor** column and scroll to the entries for the sensor you identified at the start of this procedure to verify that it passes the Sysmon filter. For example:



Collecting Installation Logs for Troubleshooting

If the Windows Server Sensor installation fails, you can rerun the installer with verbose logging enabled to capture detailed diagnostic information. Add the following parameter to the installation command:

```
/l*v C:\temp\msi.log
```

This option generates a detailed MSI installation log at `C:\temp\msi.log`, which can be reviewed to help identify the cause of the installation failure.

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